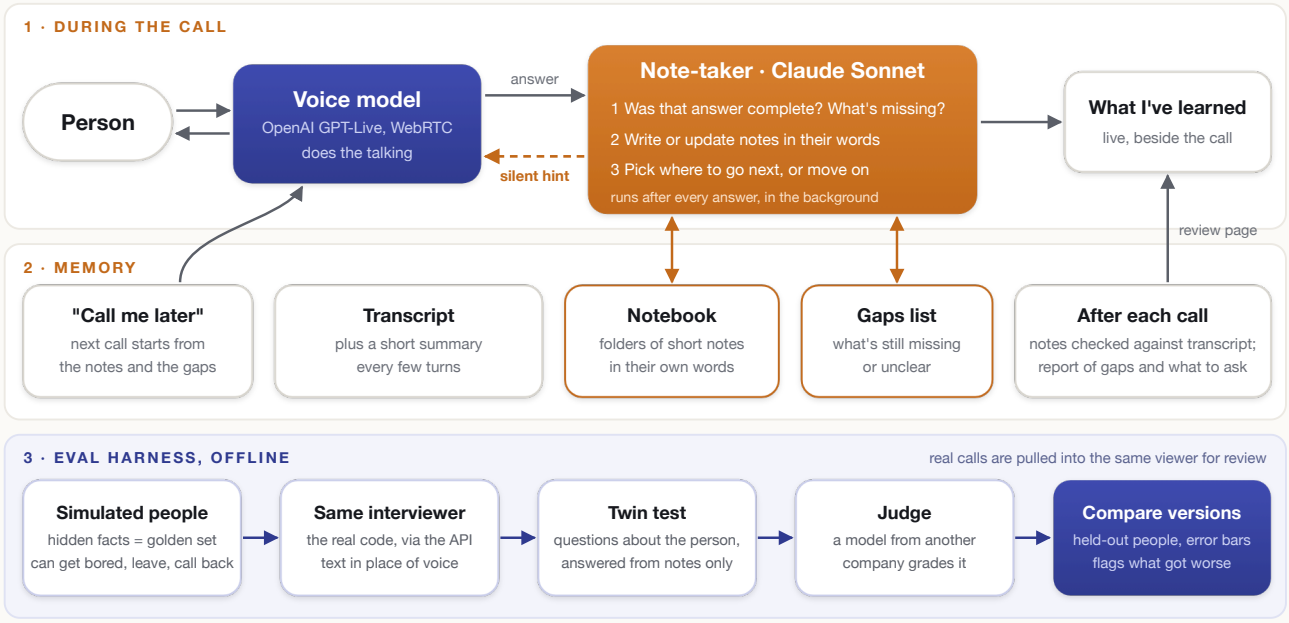
VIVEN AI · INTERVIEWER AND EVAL HARNESS · NOVEMBER 2026

How the interviewer gets what someone knows onto paper, and how I measure it

You asked for two things: an interviewer that can draw out what any person knows, by voice, without annoying them; and a way to tell how much it actually captured and what got worse when the prompt changed. Below is how the system is built and where each part of your ask lives.



The question "was that answer complete, and what's missing?" is asked twice: live, to choose the next question, and offline, to score a version of the interviewer.

WHAT YOU ASKED FOR, AND WHERE IT LIVES

"Tacit knowledge from any human. Any human."	**No question list.** It first finds out what the person does and what they're known for, then goes deep only where an answer differs from what anyone would say.
"Is that the complete answer? What is a fuller answer? Is there a knowledge gap?"	**Step 1 of the note-taker**, after every answer. Open gaps go into the gaps list and steer the next question.
"Try it once more, twice, then move on… you don't want to piss them off."	**Same check decides "enough".** A vague answer gets a different angle, not the same question again. If they push back, it moves on.
"Can you call me later?… not starting all over again."	**One memory per person.** Hang up any time; the next call opens on what they said last and picks up the next gap.
"Golden set… you captured 50%, tuned the prompt, now 70%."	**Hidden facts per simulated person.** I score how many came out, how many reached the notes, and compare two versions on the same people.
"Did something else fail? Did people drop off, go off on a tangent?"	**Regression checks in every run:** who left early and why, repeated or two-part questions, filler, notes not backed by the transcript.
"How do you know you've actually captured all the knowledge?"	**The twin test.** Another model answers outsiders' questions about the person from the notes alone. Wrong or made-up answers show what's missing.

2–8 s → 1 s	**0.12 → 0.23**	**2.0 → 2.8**	**32% → 16%**
reply time, after letting the voice model lead	share of hidden facts drawn out, after the notebook rework	areas of each person's life covered, latest round	questions that asked two things at once

One Durable Object per person on Cloudflare Workers, people in D1; the same code runs as a plain Node server. Text model calls go through OpenRouter; the judge is never from the same company as the interviewer.

Experiment log: THINKING.md